Emotions and feelings

The same blue can awaken **calm** in one of us and **longing** in another, sometimes even both in one day.

Blue can awaken in us a slowing down, the wish to talk and also coldness and **distance**. There is no single fixed effect. It depends on our body, experience, culture and situation.

Emotions

Quick and strong reactions that can appear even before you realise them.

Calm

It can bring a feeling that you can **take a breath**. Slowing down, **quiet**, **distance** from the rush. The body lets go.

And why?

Blue is the colour of sky and the surface of water. It forces us to nothing and the eye can stop in it. It is not automatic, though. The same shade can remind one woman that she can breathe out, and another a hospital corridor.

If I asked you now

"Where is your surface on which it feels good to rest?"

Sadness

Heaviness and **melancholy**. But also a soft, **quiet** mood that can be beautiful too.

And why?

In English they say *feeling blue* and the music genre blues is linked with sadness. Blue tends to be the colour of evening, rain and distance. The colour does not cause **sadness**, it rather gives it room so that it is not loud.

Ask yourself

"What am I missing today?"

Loneliness

A feeling that there is distance between me and others. Sometimes a protective **distance**, sometimes a coldness that hurts.

And why?

Blue is a cool colour and we perceive coolness as distance. It can protect, but also separate. **Solitude** that you choose is different from the kind that has happened to you.

Try asking yourself

*"Is my **solitude** chosen, or did it happen to me?"*

Trust

A feeling that someone or something can be relied on. Sobriety, order.

And why?

Uniforms, banks, offices, healthcare. Blue has learned that it seems trustworthy. This **trust** can be pleasant, but also tiring when the same **reliability** is always expected of you.

A question for you

*"Whom **can you** rely on?"*

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Feelings and experience

Less immediate than emotions. They say more about how we feel in a situation, in the body and in relation to ourselves.

Perspective and space

A feeling of **overview**. I see things from a distance and they do not seem so big.

And why?

Sky and sea. Blue invites us to look further than the nearest problem. **Perspective** does not help when you need closeness, so it is good to know both.

Ask yourself

"What would change if I looked at it from a distance?"

Words that want out

The wish to say what is on my mind. A feeling that the words are ready and are only still looking for the first sentence.

And why?

Blue is linked with speaking and expression (in the yogic tradition with the Vishuddha chakra, more about it below). It is calm, in no hurry and listens, and so it is often easier to open up in it. It is not a law, though.

If I asked you now

"What would you like to say that you have not said yet?"

Coldness and distance

A feeling that it is cold around me. Sometimes a pleasant **distance** from people, sometimes a wish to move closer to warmth.

And why?

In painting blue is counted among the cool colours. In the same room one person perceives it as fresh and another woman as a cold waiting room. If a particular blue takes your energy, that is useful information for choosing a colour for your home or a picture.

Try asking yourself

"What would warm this room or this picture?"

Depth and quiet

A feeling that beneath the surface there is something that does not want to come up yet. A **quiet depth**, sometimes mysterious, sometimes heavy.

And why?

A dark, midnight blue resembles night and the deep sea. For some women it gives a feeling of safety, for others heaviness. What decides is how you feel in it.

Ask yourself

"What lies beneath my surface?"

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My blue is not the same as your blue

A colour itself does not experience anything. We experience it. When we first see a colour together with something strong (a smell, a face, a situation, a word), the experience sticks to it. The colour then becomes a shortcut. It is enough to catch sight of it and the body knows whether it can relax or should withdraw. That is why your own reaction matters most.

- **The sea**
  For one freedom and a holiday, for another fear of depth and of not seeing the bottom.
- **A blue uniform**
  For one a feeling of order and trust, for another school, an office or a job she wants to escape from.
- **Hospital blue**
  Relief and care, or fear and waiting for news.

Some colours we put aside. After a hard period we get rid of a dress or avoid a place. It is a way of protecting ourselves. And when we are ready, blue often comes back by itself, first as a piece of sky in the window, then as a scarf.

When to make blue smaller or put it away

You notice you do not want to look at a rich area, a room feels cold to you, or a dark blue feels oppressive. **You do not have to** endure it because of a rule about **calm**. Take off a blue throw, turn the picture round or hide an accessory for a day.

Mental hygiene. A small space without demands

After a day full of screens, replies and other people's needs, when you want to stop reacting for a while. Sit by a window with a view of a piece of sky, or put a blue picture you like in a quiet corner. Put the phone aside. **You do not have to** concentrate on the colour, it is enough that it is there.

A question for you

"Which sentence about blue is loudest in you? Whose is it?"

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